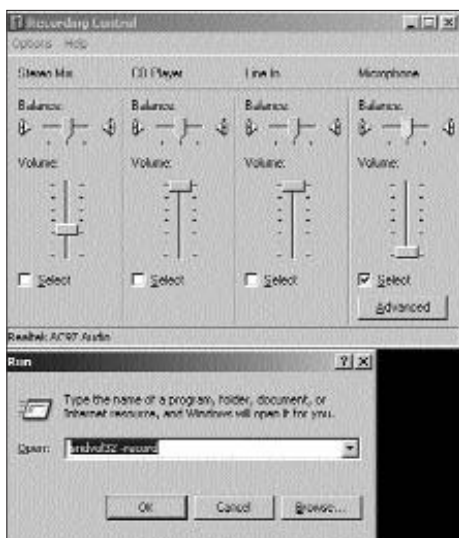


reflected sound off in a different direction rather than straight back at you.

The next thing to do is try and use headphones instead of speakers. This is because, with the default settings, anything you input into the PC is output through the speakers. So if you speak into a microphone, unless you specifically mute its output, your voice will be played back through your speakers. This can cause feedback or weird echoes, and you certainly want none of that!

If you just have to use speakers, make sure you mute the microphone output. You can do this by double-clicking the speaker icon on the task bar and muting the microphone. Don't worry—this will not cause your microphone to stop picking up sound; it will just prevent the sounds picked up from being instantly played back through your speakers. If you have to hear what you're saying, for reassurance, pull down the microphone volume to an extent where you can just about hear its output from your speakers. Also, make sure your speakers are pointed away from the microphone.

Do a test record, for which you can use Microsoft's own Sound Recorder. Go to Start > Programs > Accessories > Entertainment > Sound Recorder. You will see the Sound Recorder window. Click on the big red record button to start recording. If you're going to be speaking into the microphone,



You can use the "sndvol32 -record" command to get directly to Recording Control